

Team Name and Members

Group H

- Chiemego Nwokolo
- Chinedu Nwoye
- Oluwatobiloba Akinmade
- Abdurahman Khawaja

Project Sponsor

Dr. Tim Maciag (ENSE 271 Professor)

Business Need/Opportunity

Reach Autism Learning is a non-profit organization that helps families with autistic people to teach skills like reading, writing, math, and counting. The organization's website was presented to us as a team, highlighting some work that could be done to make the website more user-friendly and reach more of its desired audience.

Our team was task to create a website for Reach Autism Learning while giving them the opportunity to update their website and technology infrastructure in a sustainable way, with minimal cost to the charity, whilst simultaneously ensuring that they will be able to continue to maintain that website so long as they continue to operate. Through this collaborative partnership between the Foundation and the University of Regina, our team would explore different ways to update the designs of a charity's website and attempt to solve unique pain points experienced by both the charity and their users.

As part of course-based learning activities, our team has been provided with the opportunity to work alongside Reach Autism Learning in exploring new and innovative web designs that allow them to efficiently and effectively communicate their organizations mission/vision/values, programming/services and calls to action.

Reflections on project planning, execution, and closing.

- Northstar Customers: Individuals and families of individuals living with autism
- Carryover customers: Donors and Volunteers.

Key findings from affinity diagramming and empathy mapping.

Affinity Diagrams: Helps us understand what the customers really want in this website design and arrange in order of importance.

- The most important need or constraint was to ensure to retain all the major information generated from the website during the project.
- Following that, in terms of importance, was how to properly structure the home page. We considered putting reviews on the home page, a new update; we considered highlighting the services they offer early enough on the home page.
- We then considered fixing the functionality problems of their website.
- The logo on the website was also out of place, and we considered fixing that.
- The last on our priority list was our suggestions as we should come only after we have considered the needs of our clients. These include a reorganized gallery, visible contact button, making information easily assessable, having a bold donate button, restructuring the events page, and introducing a volunteer page.

Empathy Mapping: This map helps us feel/have empathy for the users of this website.

Think: Out Northstar customers tend to blame themselves when they haven't been able to navigate the website properly.

Hear: Too much empathy and misunderstanding from people in their everyday lives

Say: After proper navigation of the website, our NorthStar customers will still have multiple questions about the organization and what they have to offer.

Do: Keep trying until they find an alternative or hopefully use the website

Initial s evolution of the USM/MVP?

1 - 1



MVP



Figure 1: User Story Map showing MVP.

The User Story Map (USM) above shows the initial proposition of implementations to take place when building the website. Initially, we chose to include the contact us button on every page and eventually discarded that decision as it was rejected by the client. Slowly, we moved to developing the MVP, more importantly, as they were the most important things our website must have before it is technically viable to the customer. What we produced is an MVP because we strived to produce something simple yet fully functional. Every single prototype provided to the client for testing was fully functional at every stage of the design.

Summarized Prototype Activity and usability evaluation findings:

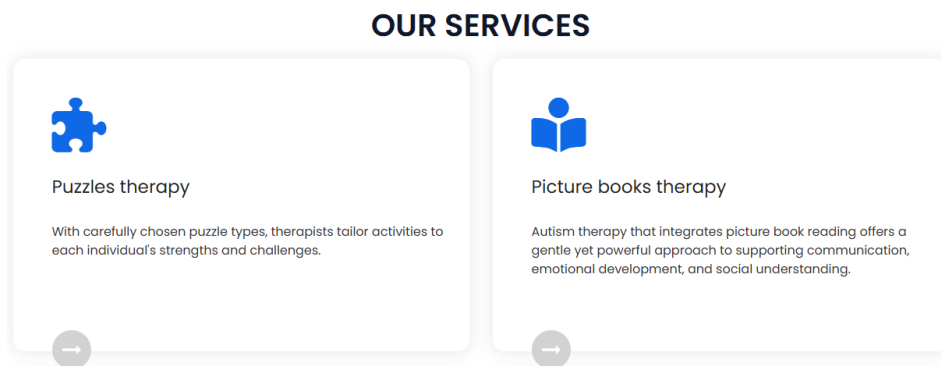
The insights below were gotten from the check-in with customers and from feedback gotten from students when performing the usability evaluation findings:

Less clicks to get what you want would help the website

- The phone number should be taken out of the contact us button
- Would prefer for the donate button to be in all pages rather than the donate button
- Would be nice to use an anchor that takes you to different locations on the website
- Would be nice to use an accordion to prepare the “about” information
- More colors
- Font style and color can be changed to show professionalism and enhance ease of viewing.
- Too much scrolling
- An arrow can be used to make it clearer that the photos and the reviews can be dragged to the left to see more.
- The volunteer page is ambiguous and does not provide clear information about where volunteers can help
- Volunteer and events can be separated.
- Sponsors could be on the “About us” page
- It would be better to use symbols, charts, and pictures to explain what they do than loads of text.
- Left-aligned text is more inviting than centered text.
- Anchor tags would be wiser to use for the major sponsors
- You might consider prioritizing Andrew’s (their son) story, as it is a huge part of their organization Would be wise to have all the board of directors seen at a glance
- It would be wise to have all the sponsors seen at a glance. Too much scrolling can be tiring for everybody.
- Logo is too stretched out. Should be the exact size
- Puzzles and rubics cube are nice
- “More info” buttons are self-explanatory
- Too much space surrounding headers on each page
- Everyone loves “reviews”.

Linking design ideas to People-centred design:

1. Gestalt:



Similarity: Our services of Reach Autism have a similar layout i.e. shape, color, size or texture and would be considered a group because they would be it is logical to place similar related information alongside each other to make they easy to understand when viewed, especially at first glance.



Proximity: The Gestalt principle of proximity has been applied here by placing the accessibility and back-to-top buttons in close proximity with each other so that the user doesn't see one and have to search for the other, as they are both quite useful and placed on the button's right-hand side of the page.

2. Affordances:



Signifiers like this have been strategically placed under major parts of the homepage to notify the user that there is more information to be found in regard to what is viewed.

3. Constraints:



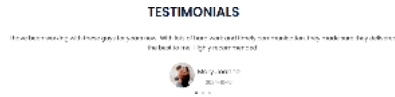
Having the user make use of the “back-to-top” button and not letting the header follow the scrolling is a constraint used in making sure the user goes to the top to select something from the menus.

Summarized Final WordPress Solution:

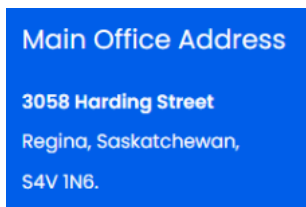
Feedback received throughout the design process was valuable to achieving the goal of completing this website. Some of them include:



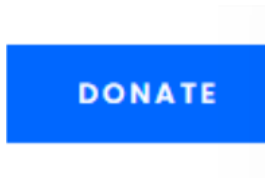
We made the logo smaller and clearer for it to be visible on the header of the page.



Testimonials from past clients were now used on the home page.



Contact Address now on the footer.



Donate button now visible on every page, and also on the header and footer menus.

Summarize how you felt about this Project(likes/dislikes):

- This project introduced our team to the concept of having to create a fully functional website without coding. At the beginning, it seemed very tedious, but with continuous use of the WordPress platform, expertise was sure.

Likes

- I liked that most shortcuts like Ctrl-Z are being used.
- The blocks are also a favourite on how the website is to be laid out.

Dislikes

- A dislike on the project is the short turnaround timeline. There is not enough time for a beginner to completely understand the different platforms used (USM, Figma, WordPress).

Summarize what went well during the project:

- All our tasks went well; right from the work to the review from the client. It felt like a real-world experience.

Summarize what did not go well during the project:

- Not being able to fully bring ideas to life because of limited expertise in the applications used for the project.

How successful was your team in translating prototypes into WordPress reality?

- This was not an easy task initially but we scaled through after constant practice, completing the tasks steps by steps and taking it one block after another.

Did the people-centred design ideas discussed in lectures help/hinder your design explorations?

- They helped our design explorations, as they exposed us to different principles and the major reason why designers use the designs/ icons they use when creating websites.
- It also enabled us to categorically understand what we were doing and how to properly group things.
- It introduced us to the concept of fully understand our customers before working on a project.

What would you do the same on future projects?

- Most definitely the gestalt principles, for example, have reshaped my reasoning and understanding that designers don't just throw stuff at us to figure out but also try to enable us to come into their space and join in their reasoning.

What would you do differently on future projects?

- Start early on every project assigned.
- Share tasks according to each team members strengths

Summarize opportunities and design ideas for future work

- With the knowledge gained from this course, a good idea to create a small e-commerce platform where students at the University of Regina can market and sell their locally made products to enhance visibility and make money.

Theme/Plugin name:

Theme: The Astra theme was the active theme used for the project's completion.

Plugins: There were various plugins used for this project, as plugins are very necessary and make creation a little bit less tedious. Some plugins used include:

1. **3CX Live Chat**
2. **Accessibility Widget by OneTap - Easy One-Click Accessibility Toolbar**
3. **Jetpack**
4. **Spectra**
5. **Starter Templates**
6. **SureForms**
7. **SureMail**
8. \

Plugin Name	User Rating	Number of Users who rated	Last Updated	Active installations	What generally does it do?
1. 3CX Live Chat	4.5/5 star	820 users	3 months ago	100,000+	The plugin includes a complete communications system for your business - for free. Call, chat, conference and collaborate with your teams and customers from your office, home or smartphone.

2.Accessibility Widget by OneTap - Easy One-Click Accessibility Toolbar	5 star	54 users	1 week ago	20,000+	OneTap is an accessibility plugin made in Europe that helps you make your WordPress website inclusive and easy to use for all visitors. With a simple one- click setup, it adds essential accessibility tools instantly – no account required. OneTap is
					multilingual, lightweight, and fully customizable, ensuring accessibility without slowing down your site.

3. Jetpack	3.5/5 star	2,351 ratings	21 hours ago	4+ million	Jetpack is a WordPress plugin that helps you create better content, grow your subscribers, earn money from your website and keep it safe, fast, and secure. You can grow and keep track of your website traffic with Jetpack stats, and create better content with Jetpack AI. You can start a newsletter and grow your audience, turning fans into paying subscribers. Create beautiful content with Jetpack Creator and keep your site fast with Jetpack Boost.
4. Spectra	4.5/5 stars	1,804 ratings	1 day ago	1+ million	Spectra equips designers with a wide range of pre-designed
					website templates, allowing them to effortlessly create professional websites tailored to their unique requirements.

5. Starter Templates	5/5 stars	4,706 ratings	1 week ago	2+ million	With Starter Templates, you can create a stunning website in a matter of minutes. Simply describe the idea, and watch as a WordPress website is built before your eyes.
6. SureForms	5/5 stars	53 ratings	3 days ago	300,00+	SureForms is a beginner-friendly form plugin that makes building contact forms and other high-converting custom forms fast and simple with advanced features like multi-step forms, conversational forms, conditional logic, etc.
7. UpdraftPlus	5/5 stars	8,237 ratings	3 weeks ago	3+ million	UpdraftCentral is a powerful remote control dashboard for WordPress that allows you to manage your backups, as well as updates, users, pages, posts, plugins and themes from one central location. Choose between

8. SureMail	5/5 stars	22 ratings	1 week ago	200,000+	SureMail is built to ensure your WordPress emails are delivered—every
					time, without fail. Whether you need one-off emails or regular newsletters, you can trust SureMail to handle all your email delivery needs with reliability and ease.